A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

22 April 2026

Dr Lucien Reynald
Valewood Clinic

Dear Dr Reynald,

Re: Mrs Margaret Jacobs
DOB: 1944-11-06
Address: 231/101 Whalley Drive, WHEELERS HILL, VIC, 3150

Summary

- **Significant improvement in bowel control and urgency following implementation of fibre supplementation and pelvic floor physiotherapy.**
- **High levels of patient engagement in rehabilitation strategies.**
- **Reassurance provided regarding the absence of mucosal damage or increased malignancy risk.**
- **For review on an as-needed basis.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a review with Maggie. You will be pleased to know that she has experienced a improvement in her symptoms since our last consultation. She reports a significant increase in her confidence and has successfully resumed social activities, which were previously limited by her bowel symptoms.

The primary drivers of this success appear to be her diligent adherence to a fibre supplementation programme, specifically using partially hydrolysed guar gum, and her sessions with pelvic floor physiotherapist, Cherry. Margaret has been highly motivated to implement the strategies taught in physiotherapy. Importantly, her assessment with the physiotherapist confirmed that her anal sphincter complex is intact and functional. This has allowed her to utilise deferral techniques effectively, mitigating her previous fear of public accidents.

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

In addition to her physical rehabilitation, Margaret has engaged with a psychiatrist to address the psychological burden of her chronic symptoms and the impact of her recent bereavement. This multidisciplinary approach has clearly empowered her, and she now feels more proactive in managing her condition.

During the consultation, we addressed Margaret's concerns regarding whether previous periods of acute physiological stress and a history of a bowel abscess could have caused permanent damage to her intestinal villi or increased her risk of colorectal malignancy. I have reassured her that her previous health issues have not predisposed her to bowel cancer and that there is no clinical suspicion of malabsorptive pathology or structural damage at this time.

Impression and Plan

Margaret's functional bowel symptoms are currently well-managed through lifestyle modification, fibre supplementation, and pelvic floor rehabilitation. She will continue her sessions with the physiotherapist to further refine her bowel mechanics. We have agreed that no further invasive investigations, such as a gastroscopy or colonoscopy, are required at this stage. I have advised her that should she develop any "red flag" symptoms, such as haematochezia or unexplained weight loss, she should contact me for a formal review. Otherwise, I have transitioned her to an as-needed follow-up schedule.

Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

CC: Mrs Cherry De Crespigny

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065